

the best places to build temples, or heiaus, and divine omens from the spirit world.

The kapu, the Menehune system of taboos, is regulated by the kahunas. They can change taboos through divination with the spirit world, providing the spirits agree, though sometimes the spirits demand new taboos. New taboos, or changes to the existing ones, are only made if a majority of the kahunas agree.

If someone breaks a taboo, a kahuna is consulted on how to best appease the spirits. In the past, spirits would often demand the death of the transgressor, but with the dwindling Menehune population, this is a rare occurrence.

Kahuna often specialize in an area of lore, whether astronomy, geology, herb lore, farming, etc. This knowledge is shared with the other kahuna and used for the benefit of the whole village.

Kahunas seek out naturally-occurring sacred places deep in the wilderness. Here they watch and listen for signs of the will of the gods. Signs can come in many forms: a flowering branch, the wind through the palms, or even the rumble of a distant volcano. A kahuna is constantly alert for omens all around him.

Kahunas have no standard appearance; they can be tall or short, heavy or slender. It is their eyes that betray their true nature. At night, their eyes shine with the light of the stars. They usually wear ceremonial robes and adornment.

Affinity: Nature

BIRTHRIGHTS

Break Taboo — Kahuna may break a taboo without suffering the consequences. However, the breaking of taboo must be done with respect, and may only be done once per lunar month. The Kahuna must spend a point of Mana to use this Birthright.

Spirit Speech — Kahuna can speak with and understand the language of all spirits. Other Menehune can only communicate with their own totems.

FRAILTIES

Omens — A kahuna's ability to hear spirits comes with a price — sometimes he is not able to shut out the voices, and he goes into a trancelike state as he tries to glean an omen out of the soft whispers of the spirits around him. The Storyteller can invoke this effect once per session.

"The spirits have spoken: you have broken taboo. You must appease Pele by going to her very womb."

hana

The hana are the builders, crafters, makers, and artisans of the Menehune. They built many of the famous platforms, ditches, and heiaus that are scattered throughout the islands. Farmers and fishermen are also common among the hana, and they are by far the most numerous of the Menehune.

Most hana prefer to work in groups whenever possible, and they are always busy with some project. A group of hana may be working on the construction of a building while a hana skilled at singing entertains the workers with song as they labor.

The Menehune village is a subsistence culture and the hana must work continuously to keep everyone fed, clothed, and entertained. They also spend a great deal of their time amongst humans, quietly reminding them of the old ways. Hana can almost always be found at human festivals and gatherings that celebrate traditional Hawai'ian culture.

The hana are the heart of the Menehune. Without them there would be no food on the plates or clothes on the backs of the chiefs, priests, and warriors. Why rule an empty village? Who is there to fight for without the hana? Sadly, this fact is often forgotten by the other callings, and the hana patiently remind them, usually with a quiet word, but sometimes with pranks. It is not taboo to disassemble the high kahuna's hut as he sleeps, or to serve the chief bitter fruit.

Hana are likely to be found wherever the craft takes them: carving canoes on the beach, collecting flowers for leis, gathering taro from the fields, building a spit for roast pig, or just about any other activity that makes up the life of a traditional Hawai'ian commoner. They are very social and work well with other Menehune, except the kokua, whom they mistrust.

Like their boggan cousins, the hana are often short and plump. Their hands are usually rough and calloused from long days of labor or practicing their craft. They tend to wear the traditional garments of Hawai'ian mortals of ages past.

Affinity: Prop

BIRTHRIGHTS

Craftwork — When a group of hana work together, they can build just about any traditional structure in one night. Also, a single hana can create any item in half the time that would normally be required. A hana must be unseen by mortal observers to use this Birthright.

Song — A hana's song warms, empowers, and lightens all who hear it. Once per chapter, the hana may sing (requiring a successful Charisma + Expression roll from the player, difficulty 7). Anyone who hears it regains a point of Willpower.

FRAILTIES

Abandonment — If, for some reason, a hana cannot complete a task in the time he declares at the start, he must leave it uncompleted and never return to it. To return to it is the equivalent of breaking taboo, and the hana gains a dot of Banality. If another hana attempts to finish the task, that character's player must roll Mana (difficulty 7) to avoid gaining a point of Banality.

"We are the growers, the makers, and the fishers. We keep the kokua strong, and allow the ali'i to lead and the kahuna to watch the stars. Without us nothing would exist."

Kokua

The kokua are the warriors of the Menehune, charged with the defense of their people against all enemies. In the past, the enemy was often Menehune from other villages, but today they guard against incursions by humans, Western fae, and other supernatural foes. It is a difficult and often dangerous